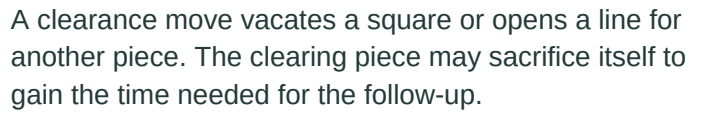


Clearance tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

Previous move: 28.Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

28...Ng4 29. Qc5 Qh2+ 30. Kf1 Be3

28...Ng4 The knight moves from f6 to g4. The changed line means the bishop on g5 attacks the queen on e7. Recorded reply: **29.Qc5**.

29...Qh2+ Check restricts White to 1 legal reply here. Recorded reply: **30.Kf1**.

30...Be3 The bishop moves from g5 to e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 21 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +0. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

Using $P=1$, $N/B=3$, $R=5$, $Q=9$, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +0: the balance goes from -1 to -1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.